LESSON 1

Rain, Rain, Go Away

A rhyme children have chanted on rainy days for hundreds of years: one version was printed in 1659, in a book of English proverbs.

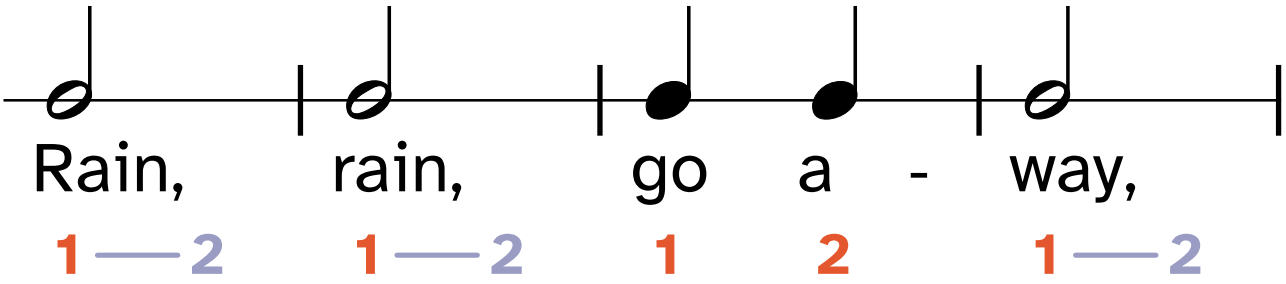
IN THIS SONG **three black keys side by side** **high, middle, low** **walk and hold** **fingers 2 3 4**

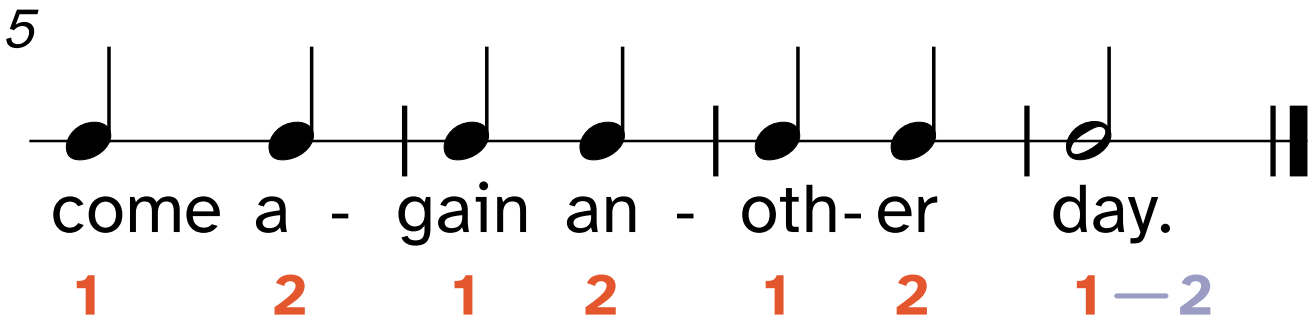
1 Say and clap

Say the words in time, then clap them and count: clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey ones.

THE BEAT **Count 1 2** in every bar, steady as a clock: two beats a bar. Walk on a beat; hold a long note for two.

THE NOTES **crotchet: walk** 1 beat ● **minim: hold** 2 beats ●●

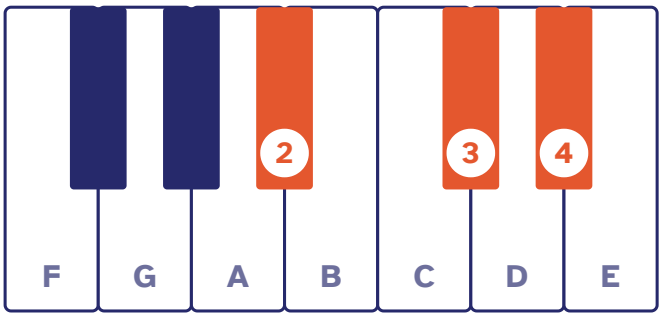




☐ Said it in time ☐ Clapped and counted ☐ Held every long note

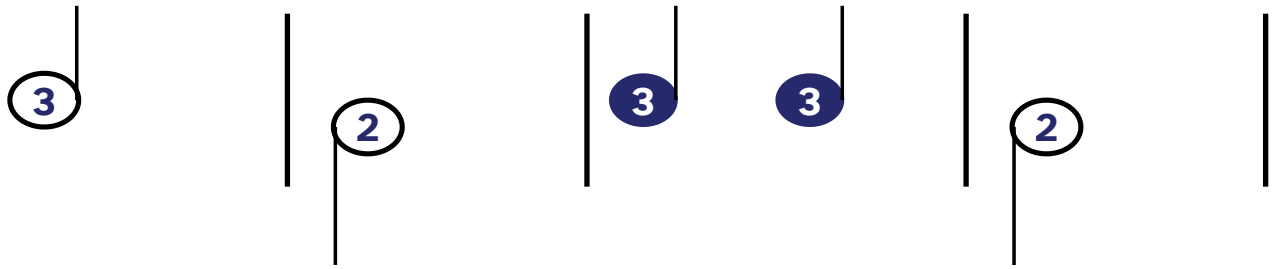
2 Listen and sing

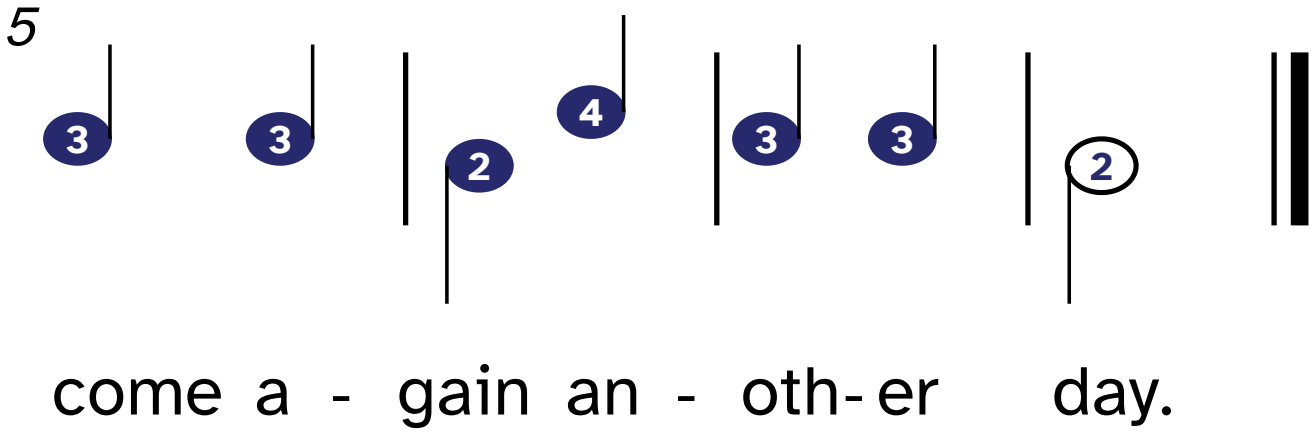
Listen first, pointing to each note as it sounds. Then sing it with the words. The number in each note is the finger that plays it; a stem down means the left hand plays it (the 2s).



Your hand. Three black keys side by side: the top key of a three, then the two across the gap. Left hand 2, right hand 3 and 4.

High, middle, low. The page draws the tune the way it sounds: the higher the note, the higher it sits.



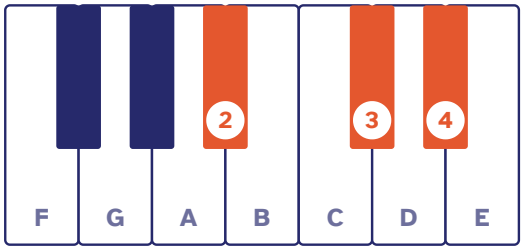


- [ ] Listened and pointed
- [ ] Sang it with the words
- [ ] Found the high note
- [ ] Played it on the black keys

SCAN ME

3 Play it

Both hands share the tune: the left hand plays the low note, the right hand the two high ones.



Left hand: 2 on the top key of the three. **Right hand:** 3 and 4 on the two, across the gap. A stem down is the left hand, a stem up the right.

Which hand? Your teacher plays one of the three keys. Say “left” or “right”, then play it back with that hand.

Hands only. Play the tune and say “left, right” instead of the words. Then sing the words as you play.

4 · CHECK

- ☐ I can say and clap it
- ☐ I can sing it with the words
- ☐ I can find the three black keys

I can play it:

☐ Slowly ☐ In time

TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet